

# 72-hour plan to the Sept 5, 2026 AoE deadline

| Day 1<br>(Sep 2)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Day 2<br>(Sep 3)                                                   | Day 3<br>(Sep 4)                                              |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| verify venue + anonymize repo copy<br>(done in this doc)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | margin-ablation retrains (nb 08)<br>(2 x ~4 min)                   | downstream probes on new checkpoint<br>(source-grouped RF)    |
| reproduce drift + baselines (nb 08, frozen)<br>(DONE: 0.954->0.594 exact)                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | AnchorGuard full retrain (nb 08)<br>(~25 min, launch overnight/AM) | sensitivity: per-source, controls<br>(missingness/provenance) |
| run readout diagnostic (nb 07)<br>(DONE: informative null)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | draft paper: results + methods<br>(5 pages, figures wired)         | finalize 5-page PDF + OpenReview<br>(anonymized, references)  |
| run surprise probe (nb 09)<br>(DONE: CP/stroke > normal)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | GATE: anchor $\geq 0.85$ ?<br>(no -> report trade-off honestly)    | submission by Sept 5 AoE<br>(with reproducibility appendix)   |
| freeze results + pre-registration<br>(write before any retrain)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                    |                                                               |
| Decision rule: keep the claim inside what the evidence supports. Primary story = quantified forgetting + mechanism + repair (nb 08); garnish = predictive surprise (nb 09) and readout diagnostic (nb 07).<br>If any gate fails, ship the informative negative - it is still a workshop-worthy result. |                                                                    |                                                               |